

Northbridge - called the MCH (memory controller hub). Contains the core logic that pertains to the CPU, RAM, graphics solution with the Southbridge. Its usually a larger more complex chip than the Southbridge

Solid state capacitors - as opposed to electrolytic capacitors SS caps have a longer life and more stable operation

PCIe x16 slots - This slot is used primarily for a graphics card. It offers extra bandwidth over the APG interface and in its current avatar supports data transfers of up to 8 GBps

PCI slots - these slots are still found on the latest boards and mainly used for attaching soundcards, modems and additional LAN cards

Southbridge - Called the ICH or I/O Controller Hub. This core logic chip is further away from the CPU and handles the slower devices on the system such as the USB ports, LAN ports, PCI and PCIe slots (except the graphics card slots)

LED Poster - This shows up the POST sequence in hex code for easy de-bugging

Jumpers - jumper enable or disable certain functions and are electrical contacts that have to be shorted in order to be activated

Header pins - these are connectivity pins on motherboards that are typically hooked up to your cabinets connectors so

Sensor chip - every motherboard has one and this chip monitors the status of core components such as memory, CPU and even graphics ports. Parameters like temperature and fan speed are reported in

Photographed by: Manas Parekh
Motherboard Courtesy: Gigabyte Technology (India) Ltd.